Zaid Sayed

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Education

University of British Columbia — Vancouver, BC

Bachelor of Arts in Computer Science, Minor in Data Science — *Sept 2023 – Dec 2027*

- **GPA:** 3.7/4.0 | International Student Scholarship Recipient (2024, 2025)
- **Teaching Assistant:** CPSC 210 (Software Construction), CPSC 121 (Models of Computation)
- **Residence Advisor** (Aug 2025 – Present): support 200+ residents and design community programs

Experience

Data Engineer Co-op — May 2026 – Aug 2026

Atreides | Python, AWS (Lambda, S3, SQS, SNS), Spark, Docker, Kubernetes, Pulumi — *Remote*

- Designed, tested and deployed production **backend services** in Python and AWS processing ∼**1 PB/day**
- Resolved production edge cases and improved **reliability** with Pydantic validation, alerting, feature flags and configuration-driven processing
- Built configurable backfill and ingestion tooling that cut raw-data access time from **hours to minutes**, shipped through **code reviews** and design discussions

AI Software Engineer → Program Manager — Aug 2023 – Aug 2024

VENU AI | Python, LLMs, OpenAI API — *San Jose, CA (Remote)*

- Built **LLM-powered automation workflows** for personalized email generation, raising response rates from **25% to 40%** through prompt and application-logic iteration
- Reviewed, debugged and refactored application code and AI workflows, reducing recurring debugging effort by ∼**40%**
- Promoted to **Program Manager within 7 months**; led small engineering teams, mentored interns and turned stakeholder requirements into shipped features

Projects

LeadFlow: Sales Outreach Backend | *Python, FastAPI, MongoDB, Redis, RQ, Docker* — Oct 2026 – Present

- Built a **REST API** with Pydantic validation, unique-index deduplication, pagination and case-insensitive **indexed search** via MongoDB collation
- Implemented **Redis cache-aside caching** with version-based invalidation and a per-key **rate limiter** using atomic counters (429 + Retry-After)
- Designed an **async job queue** with retries and backoff, idempotent jobs and atomic updates to prevent race conditions; **scaled workers horizontally** with Docker Compose

AI Email Assistant | *React, TypeScript, Ionic, Gmail API, OpenAI API* — Jan 2025

- Built a web app integrating the **Gmail and OpenAI APIs** to generate context-aware email replies
- Designed **React/TypeScript** components and a human-in-the-loop workflow to review and edit AI-generated responses before sending

Game Speedrunning Database System | *Node.js, SQL, Oracle* — Jan 2026 – Mar 2026

- Built a Node.js app on a normalized **15-table schema**, with SQL joins, aggregation and nested subqueries to compute leaderboards

Finance Budget Tracker | *Java, JUnit, Swing* — Jan 2024 – May 2024

- Built a Java desktop app using **OOP and MVC** with JSON persistence, covered by **JUnit tests**

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, Java, TypeScript/JavaScript, SQL, C, C++
Backend & Web: FastAPI, Node.js, React, REST APIs, MongoDB, Redis, PostgreSQL, RQ (job queues)
Cloud & Infra: AWS (S3, Lambda, SQS), Docker, Docker Compose, Kubernetes, Pulumi, Spark
Engineering & AI: Data Structures & Algorithms, OOP, Git/GitHub, JUnit, CI/CD, LLM Applications